

Geometric Standardisation, Hydraulic Context and CAD/BIM Reconstruction of Concrete Antifer Cubes

Ricardo Carvalho (2026)

Suggested citation

Carvalho, R. (2026). *Geometric Standardisation, Hydraulic Context and CAD/BIM Reconstruction of Concrete Antifer Cubes*.

Abstract

Concrete Antifer cubes are massive grooved unreinforced concrete artificial armour units used in rubble-mound breakwaters and related maritime protection works. They were developed in the context of the Port of Antifer, in Normandy, during the early 1970s, after hydraulic investigations indicated that a simple concrete cube did not provide the required armour-layer stability for the intended exposure. The adopted unit remained deliberately massive and robust, but introduced four lateral grooves and moderate tapering to improve hydraulic behaviour, reduce face-to-face rearrangement and preserve large resistant concrete sections.

This paper provides a technical synthesis of Antifer cubes from the viewpoints of historical development, hydraulic stability, placement effects, structural integrity, manufacture, quality control and reproducible geometric reconstruction. It also formalises the algebraic volume calculation used for the Pita Antifer geometry and the volume-normalised Carvalho dimensional convention implemented in the accompanying production script. The script generates one closed vectorial Antifer armour-unit solid from input unit weight W and concrete unit weight W_c , with exports to IFC, STL, OBJ and DXF from the same validated boundary-representation. It is a geometric CAD/BIM production and documentation tool, not a hydraulic stability design program.

The adopted Pita geometry is defined by $A/H = 1.086000$, $B/H = 1.005000$, $D/H = 0.024000$, $R/H = 0.121500$, $E/H = 0.025906459610$ and $K_V = 1.024700$. The corresponding circular-arc groove inset is $C/H = R/H - E/H = 0.095593540390$, while $C/H = 0.095600$ remains the rounded historical notation. There is no top bevel in this interpretation. The top face is a single horizontal plane at $z = H$, B is the top bounding width at that level, and D is a lateral corner-chamfer offset in plan. Each of the four side grooves is reconstructed as one continuous circular arc of radius R , with no auxiliary straight inner segment. The Carvalho convention uses the same vectorial topology and circular-arc groove construction, but applies a common plan/groove normalisation factor to the Pita-derived coefficients so that $V/H^3 = 1.000000$ and the Carvalho reference height is equal to the volume-equivalent nominal dimension $D_n = V^{1/3}$.

The volume calculation is expressed as a direct non-dimensional balance. The gross body is treated as a square frustum between the lower width A and the upper width B . The four lateral corner chamfers remove a coefficient $2d^2$, where $d = D/H$. The four grooves remove four identical circular-segment areas A_g . Therefore,

$$\frac{V}{H^3} = \frac{a^2 + ab + b^2}{3} - 2d^2 - 4A_g,$$

where $a = A/H$, $b = B/H$, $d = D/H$ and A_g is the non-dimensional area removed by one circular groove. For the Pita values used here, the gross square-frustum coefficient is 1.093617, the corner-chamfer subtraction is 0.001152, the required one-groove area is 0.01694125, the four-groove subtraction is 0.067765, and the final coefficient is exactly $V/H^3 = 1.024700$ within the algebraic precision of the adopted calculation.

The main engineering conclusion remains that Antifer hydraulic performance is not governed by the geometric coefficients alone. Armour-layer stability depends primarily on placement pattern, packing density, slope, wave climate, storm duration, damage criterion, toe and crest details and construction tolerances. Van der Meer-type concrete-unit stability formulae provide direct preliminary design relations for regular two-layer cubes and a consistent stability-number framework for Antifer sizing when Antifer-calibrated coefficients are used; Hudson-type coefficients should be interpreted as system-dependent comparative values, not intrinsic constants of the concrete shape.

Keywords: Antifer cube; concrete armour unit; rubble-mound breakwater; hydraulic stability; Hudson formula; Van der Meer stability number; Chegini-Aghtouman Antifer formula; Van der Meer nominal diameter; circular groove; Pita 1986; Carvalho 2026; CAD/BIM; IFC; STL; OBJ; DXF; volume coefficient; concrete armour geometry.

Highlights

- Antifer cubes are best interpreted as **improved massive concrete cubes**, not as slender high-interlock units.
- The documented morphology comprises a slightly tapered concrete body with **one circular-arc groove on each of the four lateral sides**.
- The adopted Pita geometry has **no top bevel**: the upper face is a single horizontal plane at $z = H$.
- In the production script, $B/H = 1.005000$ is the **top bounding width at $z = H$** for the Pita convention.
- $D/H = 0.024000$ is a **lateral corner-chamfer offset in plan**, not a vertical top set-back.
- The historical groove value $C/H = 0.095600$ is a rounded characteristic groove inset; the exact inset obtained from the volume-balance circular-arc construction is $C/H = 0.095593540390$.
- The complete Pita volume coefficient is obtained algebraically as a square frustum minus four plan-corner chamfers minus four circular-groove segments.
- The adopted Pita calculation gives $V/H^3 = 1.024700$ from first principles using $a = 1.086000$, $b = 1.005000$, $d = 0.024000$ and $r = 0.121500$.
- Carvalho (2026) is used as a volume-normalised dimensional convention with $V/H^3 = 1.000000$; it changes the Pita non-dimensional coefficients by a common plan/groove normalisation factor rather than preserving all Pita ratios unchanged.
- Hydraulic performance is governed mainly by placement method, packing density, damage definition and wave climate.
- Van der Meer concrete-unit formulae are direct preliminary stability tools for regular two-layer cubes, and Antifer stability can be treated with the same stability-number structure when Antifer-calibrated coefficients are used.
- The production script is a geometric CAD/BIM generator for IFC, STL, OBJ and DXF; it does not perform hydraulic stability design.

1. Introduction

Artificial concrete armour units are used where natural armourstone cannot be obtained in the required size, quantity, durability or cost envelope. They are particularly relevant in exposed deep-water breakwaters, port entrances and emergency repair works where armourstone of adequate nominal diameter would be difficult to quarry, handle or transport. Within this family of solutions, the Antifer cube occupies a specific technical position: it is more hydraulically refined than a plain cube, but more structurally robust and concrete-intensive than slender units that rely strongly on interlock.

The Antifer cube was developed in the early 1970s in the context of the Port of Antifer, Normandy, France. International manuals describe it as a development of the simple cube with one groove on each of the four lateral sides. The grooves improve hydraulic behaviour and interlock and reduce the tendency for smooth face-to-face rearrangement. Frens reports that the prototype Antifer harbour breakwater was built between 1976 and 1978 and that simple cubic blocks did not provide sufficient stability in the hydraulic tests, leading to the adoption of grooved blocks.

The unit became technically attractive after the structural-integrity difficulties experienced by several slender concrete armour units in the late 1970s and early 1980s. The broader lesson from structures such as Sines, Arzew El Djedid and Crescent City was that hydraulic stability and structural integrity must be assessed together. A shape may be hydraulically efficient in model tests, but if prototype units fracture under rocking, impact, fatigue, handling loads or thermal cracking, the armour layer loses both mass and engagement. The Antifer cube responded to that risk profile by retaining a compact massive body and avoiding slender arms.

This paper addresses a recurring limitation in the public technical literature: the Antifer cube is widely recognised, but its geometry is not governed by one universally available public CAD standard. Manuals describe the unit and its general construction logic; project documents and academic studies provide dimensional ratios; however, exact digital reconstruction requires a fully explicit convention.

The convention formalised here follows the production script used for vectorial CAD/BIM generation. The Pita option defines the unit in non-dimensional form using H as the historical reference height. The top width is $B = 1.005000H$ at $z = H$. There is no top bevel. The four corner chamfers are lateral plan chamfers. The lateral grooves are reconstructed as single circular arcs of radius $R = 0.121500H$. The historical volume coefficient is $K_V = 1.024700$.

The same production framework also includes a Carvalho (2026) convention. Carvalho is used as a volume-normalised dimensional reference in which $V/H^3 = 1.000000$. The convention is useful when the reported reference height is intended to coincide with the volume-equivalent nominal dimension $D_n = V^{1/3}$. It retains the same vectorial topology, two homologous horizontal sections and single circular-arc groove construction, but it does not preserve the Pita coefficients A/H , B/H , D/H , R/H and E/H unchanged. Those coefficients are horizontally normalised from the Pita coefficient so that the Carvalho coefficient set has unit volume coefficient.

The main objective of this paper is therefore twofold:

1. to summarise the engineering context of Antifer cubes as hydraulic and structural armour units; and

2. to give a complete, reproducible algebraic definition of the Pita Antifer geometry and the Carvalho volume-normalised dimensional convention used by the production CAD/BIM generator.

The intended readership is coastal, port and maritime engineers involved in armour-unit selection, physical modelling, rehabilitation design, construction quality control or geometric reconstruction of concrete armour units.

2. Sources, Evidence Classes and Method

This paper is a documentary synthesis and geometric standardisation study. It does not report new physical model tests, prototype monitoring or finite-element structural-integrity simulations.

The source base comprises historical design references, international manuals, laboratory studies, thesis work, peer-reviewed papers, project records and the associated geometry-generation implementation. The interpretation follows a conservative hierarchy of evidence.

Evidence class	Meaning in this paper	Examples of use
Primary technical reference	Manual, standard, thesis, physical-model report or peer-reviewed paper with direct technical content	geometry, stability formulae, structural-integrity interpretation, manufacture and quality control
Project or prototype record	Named structure, quantities, construction record, official communication or prototype monitoring paper	adoption cases and project context
Derived geometric evidence	Vectorial reconstruction, algebraic volume balance, IFC/STL/OBJ/DXF exports and dimensional consistency checks	CAD/BIM reconstruction and geometric standardisation
Contextual evidence	Review literature or related armour-unit research that informs interpretation but does not define the geometry	broader discussion of concrete armour-unit evolution and structural robustness

The paper separates three levels of analysis.

Level	Scope	Main risk if confused
Hydraulic design level	armour-layer stability under wave action	treating K_D as an intrinsic property of the block
Geometric reference level	published or historical dimensional coefficients	mixing incompatible definitions of B , C , D or r

Level	Scope	Main risk if confused
CAD/BIM production level	IFC/STL/OBJ/DXF geometry generated from explicit coefficients	producing visually plausible but algebraically inconsistent geometry

This separation is essential because a historical coefficient such as V/H^3 is meaningful only when the corresponding geometric construction is stated.

3. Nomenclature

Symbol	Meaning	Typical unit
A	lower external width of the Antifer body at $z = 0$	m
B	upper external width at $z = H$ in the adopted Pita drawing convention	m
C	historical groove inset / characteristic maximum groove depth	m
D	lateral corner-chamfer offset in plan	m
D_n	Van der Meer nominal diameter, $D_n = V^{1/3}$	m
H	total Antifer cube height	m
H_D	design wave height used in Hudson-type sizing	m
H_s	significant wave height	m
$H_{1/10}$	mean of the highest one-tenth of wave heights	m
K_D	Hudson stability coefficient	-
K_V	historical non-dimensional volume coefficient, V/H^3	-
A_g	non-dimensional area of one circular groove segment	-
R	absolute circular-groove radius	m
r	non-dimensional groove radius, $r = R/H$	-
E	outside offset of the circular-arc centre from the side face	m

Symbol	Meaning	Typical unit
e	non-dimensional outside centre offset, $e = E/H$	-
q	non-dimensional groove half-opening	-
V	armour-unit volume	m^3
W	unit weight in force units	kN or N
W_c	concrete unit weight in practical notation	kN/m^3
a	non-dimensional bottom width, $a = A/H$	-
b	non-dimensional top width, $b = B/H$	-
c	non-dimensional historical groove inset, $c = C/H$	-
d	non-dimensional chamfer offset, $d = D/H$	-
α	armour-slope angle	degrees or through $\cot \alpha$
Δ	relative submerged density, $\rho_c/\rho_w - 1$ or $\gamma_c/\gamma_w - 1$	-

4. Historical and Technical Development of the Antifer Cube

4.1 From simple cube to grooved cube

The plain concrete cube is the simplest substitute for natural armourstone. Its stability arises mainly from submerged weight and friction. It is easy to fabricate, easy to handle and structurally robust, but it is vulnerable to hydraulic inefficiencies associated with regularisation, low roughness, reduced permeability and face-to-face arrangements.

The Antifer cube modifies the simple cube by adding one groove on each of the four lateral faces. The resulting unit remains massive, but the lateral recesses:

- interrupt broad flat contact planes;
- reduce the probability of smooth face-to-face packing;
- increase roughness and local turbulence at the armour surface;
- improve mechanical engagement between adjacent units;
- preserve thick concrete webs and large resistant sections.

The lack of one universally enforced public geometry is central to the present paper. Digital reconstruction must therefore state the coefficient family, the meaning of each symbol and the exact geometric construction used to generate the drawing or solid.

4.2 Position within the evolution of concrete armour units

Concrete armour units may be interpreted through four broad families.

Family	Typical examples	Dominant stabilising mechanism	Structural implication
Massive or blocky units	cube, Antifer cube, modified cube	own weight, friction and limited interlock	low slenderness, high robustness, high concrete consumption
Double-layer interlocking units	Tetrapod, Dolos, Akmon	own weight plus interlock	higher hydraulic efficiency but greater sensitivity to breakage
Single-layer interlocking units	Accropode, Core-Loc, Xbloc	high interlock in one layer	efficient, but dependent on strict placement and no-damage design
Regular pattern or hollow units	Seabee, Haro, Cob, Shed, Diode	frictional restraint and/or high porosity	high performance when placement tolerances are achieved

The Antifer cube belongs to the massive/blocky family, but with enhanced surface geometry. It should therefore not be reduced to a plain cube in digital representation. Conversely, it should not be treated as a slender high-interlock unit; its structural value lies in avoiding slender arms and high tensile-stress concentrations.

4.3 Structural-integrity context after major breakwater failures

The period after the Sines, Arzew El Djedid and Crescent City failures created a paradigm shift in concrete armour-unit design. These failures highlighted the risk of relying on hydraulic model stability while underestimating prototype structural behaviour. Unit selection cannot be based on hydraulic stability alone. A stable armour layer requires:

- adequate hydraulic resistance to displacement;
- acceptable rocking and impact levels;
- sufficient tensile strength and fatigue resistance;
- adequate thermal control during curing;
- correct placement and packing;
- tolerance-compatible underlayer and toe construction;
- post-storm inspection where movement is expected.

This is why Antifer cubes remain relevant even when more concrete-efficient alternatives exist. Their robust geometry may be preferable where wave-climate uncertainty, construction-tolerance limitations, emergency repairs, foundation deformation or structural-integrity concerns dominate the design problem.

5. Geometric Definition and Algebraic Volume of the Pita and Carvalho Antifer Cube

5.1 Adopted dimensional convention

The production geometry is defined by a small set of non-dimensional coefficients referred to the total height H . The Pita convention preserves the historical dimensional reference. The Carvalho convention uses the same vectorial topology and circular-arc groove construction, but it is horizontally normalised so that $V/H^3 = 1.000000$.

Symbol or quantity	Pita value	Carvalho value	Meaning
$K_V = V/H^3$	1.024700000000	1.000000000000	non-dimensional volume coefficient
f	1.000000000000	0.987874174182	common plan/groove normalisation factor
$a = A/H$	1.086000000000	1.072831353161	bottom bounding width at $z = 0$
$b = B/H$	1.005000000000	0.992813545052	top bounding width at $z = H$
$d = D/H$	0.024000000000	0.023708980180	lateral corner-chamfer offset in plan
$r = R/H$	0.121500000000	0.120026712163	circular-groove radius
$e = E/H$	0.025906459610	0.025592322393	outside centre offset of groove circle
$c = C/H = r - e$	0.095593540390	0.094434389770	exact circular-arc groove inset
historical C/H notation	0.095600000000	not applicable	rounded historical Pita notation
q/H	0.118705961731	0.117266553915	groove half-opening
$2q/H$	0.237411923462	0.234533107831	full groove opening

The adopted geometric interpretation is the same for both conventions.

Geometric item	Adopted production interpretation
Top face	single horizontal plane at $z = H$
Top bevel	none
B	top bounding width measured at $z = H$
D	lateral plan-chamfer offset at the four corners
Side grooves	four identical single circular arcs

Geometric item	Adopted production interpretation
Groove radius	absolute radius $R = rH$
Groove centre	outside the corresponding side face by $E = eH$
Auxiliary straight inner groove segment	none
Horizontal sections	two homologous sections: lower A at $z = 0$ and upper B at $z = H$

5.2 Shared non-dimensional volume model

The geometric volume model is a square frustum minus four lateral plan-corner chamfers and four identical circular-groove segments.

Component	Non-dimensional expression	Role in volume balance
Gross square frustum	$K_{\text{frustum}} = (a^2 + ab + b^2)/3$	starting body between widths $A = aH$ and $B = bH$
Four corner chamfers	$K_{\text{corners}} = 2d^2$	plan-corner volume removed through the height
One circular groove	$A_g = r^2 \cos^{-1}(e/r) - e\sqrt{r^2 - e^2}$	area removed by one lateral groove in H^2 units
Four circular grooves	$K_{\text{grooves}} = 4A_g$	total groove-volume subtraction
Final coefficient	$K_V = K_{\text{frustum}} - K_{\text{corners}} - K_{\text{grooves}}$	resulting V/H^3

The groove half-opening and inset are derived quantities.

Derived groove quantity	Expression
groove half-opening	$q = \sqrt{r^2 - e^2}$
full groove opening	$2q$
exact groove inset	$c = r - e$

5.3 Pita full geometric volume calculation

The Pita volume calculation is closed by imposing $K_V = 1.024700000000$ and solving the single-arc groove offset e for the required groove area.

Calculation item	Expression	Value
bottom coefficient	a	1.086000000000
top coefficient	b	1.005000000000
chamfer coefficient	d	0.024000000000
groove-radius coefficient	r	0.121500000000
target volume coefficient	K_V	1.024700000000
a^2	1.086000^2	1.179396000000

Calculation item	Expression	Value
ab	1.086000×1.005000	1.091430000000
b^2	1.005000^2	1.010025000000
gross frustum coefficient	$(a^2 + ab + b^2)/3$	1.093617000000
d^2	0.024000^2	0.000576000000
four-chamfer subtraction	$2d^2$	0.001152000000
coefficient after chamfers	$K_{\text{frustum}} - K_{\text{corners}}$	1.092465000000
total groove subtraction required	$1.092465000000 - 1.024700000000$	0.067765000000
one-groove area required	$A_g = 0.067765000000/4$	0.016941250000
solved centre offset	e solving $A_g = r^2 \cos^{-1}(e/r) - e\sqrt{r^2 - e^2}$	0.025906459610
exact circular-arc inset	$c = r - e$	0.095593540390
groove half-opening	$q = \sqrt{r^2 - e^2}$	0.118705961731
full groove opening	$2q$	0.237411923462
four-groove subtraction	$4A_g$	0.067765000000
final Pita coefficient	$1.093617000000 - 0.001152000000 - 0.067765000000$	1.024700000000

The Pita dimensional scaling follows directly from $V = W/W_c$.

Quantity	Pita dimensional relation
concrete volume	$V = W/W_c$
reference height	$H = (V/1.024700000000)^{1/3}$
bottom width	$A = 1.086000000000H$
top width	$B = 1.005000000000H$
corner chamfer	$D = 0.024000000000H$
groove radius	$R = 0.121500000000H$
groove centre offset	$E = 0.025906459610H$
exact groove inset	$C = 0.095593540390H$
historical rounded groove inset	$C \approx 0.095600H$
groove half-opening	$Q = 0.118705961731H$
full groove opening	$2Q = 0.237411923462H$

5.4 Carvalho full geometric volume calculation

The Carvalho convention is obtained by applying a common horizontal normalisation factor to the Pita plan and groove coefficients. Since the vertical reference height remains H , the volume coefficient scales with f^2 .

Normalisation item	Expression	Value
Pita coefficient	$K_{V,P}$	1.024700000000

Normalisation item	Expression	Value
Carvalho coefficient	$K_{V,C}$	1.000000000000
common horizontal factor	$f = \sqrt{K_{V,C}/K_{V,P}}$	0.987874174182
coefficient-area factor	f^2	0.975895384015

Carvalho coefficient	Calculation from Pita	Carvalho value
$a_C = A/H$	$1.086000000000f$	1.072831353161
$b_C = B/H$	$1.005000000000f$	0.992813545052
$d_C = D/H$	$0.024000000000f$	0.023708980180
$r_C = R/H$	$0.121500000000f$	0.120026712163
$e_C = E/H$	$0.025906459610f$	0.025592322393
$c_C = C/H = r_C - e_C$	$0.095593540390f$	0.094434389770
q_C/H	$0.118705961731f$	0.117266553915
$2q_C/H$	$0.237411923462f$	0.234533107831

The full Carvalho volume balance is therefore the scaled counterpart of the Pita balance.

Calculation item	Expression	Value
gross frustum coefficient	$1.093617000000f^2$	1.067255782180
four-chamfer subtraction	$0.001152000000f^2$	0.001124231482
coefficient after chamfers	$1.092465000000f^2$	1.066131550698
one-groove area	$0.016941250000f^2$	0.016532887674
four-groove subtraction	$4A_{g,C}$	0.066131550698
final Carvalho coefficient	$1.067255782180 - 0.001124231482 - 0.066131550698$	1.000000000000

The Carvalho dimensional scaling is simpler because its reference height equals the nominal volume dimension.

Quantity	Carvalho dimensional relation
concrete volume	$V = W/W_c$
reference height	$H = V^{1/3} = D_n$
bottom width	$A = 1.072831353161H$
top width	$B = 0.992813545052H$
corner chamfer	$D = 0.023708980180H$
groove radius	$R = 0.120026712163H$
groove centre offset	$E = 0.025592322393H$
exact groove inset	$C = 0.094434389770H$
groove half-opening	$Q = 0.117266553915H$

Quantity	Carvalho dimensional relation
full groove opening	$2Q = 0.234533107831H$

5.5 Pita and Carvalho taper-angle comparison

With no top bevel, the main lateral taper is controlled by A and B over the full height H .

Convention	Per-side reduction $(a - b)/2$	Angle from vertical	Bottom/main lateral angle
Pita	0.040500000000	2.319211595500°	87.680788404500°
Carvalho	0.040008904054	2.291099939000°	87.708900061000°

5.6 Nominal diameter relation

The Van der Meer nominal diameter is $D_n = V^{1/3}$. The relation between D_n and the adopted reference height depends on the volume convention.

Convention	Volume relation	Nominal diameter relation	Interpretation
Pita	$V = 1.024700H^3$	$D_n = 1.008166460709H$	historical drawing height is slightly smaller than D_n
Carvalho	$V = 1.000000H^3$	$D_n = H$	reference height equals the volume-equivalent nominal diameter

6. Comparative Parametrisation and Interpretation

6.1 Pita geometry as the active documented profile

The Pita geometry is treated here as the active documented drawing profile. It is defined by the following algebraic relations:

Quantity	Relation
Volume coefficient	$V = 1.024700H^3$
Bottom width	$A = 1.086000H$
Top width	$B = 1.005000H$
Historical groove inset	$C = 0.095600H$
Exact volume-balanced groove inset	$C_{\text{exact}} = 0.095593540390H$
Corner chamfer offset	$D = 0.024000H$
Groove radius	$R = 0.121500H$
Groove centre offset	$E = 0.025906459610H$
Groove half-opening	$q = 0.118705961731H$
Groove full opening	$2q = 0.237411923462H$
Main lateral angle from vertical	2.319211595500°

Quantity	Relation
Bottom/main lateral angle	87.680788404500°

This formulation should be preferred over a visual-only drawing because it makes the volume coefficient auditable.

6.2 Relationship with Frens-type descriptions

Frens-type descriptions are close to the Pita family in morphological terms and are important because they connect geometry with placement-method experiments. However, Frens is not implemented as a separate active drawing profile in the attached script. Any Frens-specific digital generator would need to state its own exact definitions of A , B , C , D , r , groove topology and volume coefficient.

The greater importance of Frens lies in the hydraulic evidence. The thesis demonstrates that Antifer-block stability is strongly controlled by placement method and packing density. Reported K_D values span a broad interval depending on arrangement, accuracy and density, showing that armour-layer architecture dominates small differences in geometric ratios.

6.3 Relationship with Carvalho-type normalisations

The Carvalho (2026) convention is a volume-normalised dimensional reference for CAD/BIM production and nominal-diameter reporting. Its purpose is not to keep the Pita coefficients unchanged, but to keep the Pita construction logic while changing the horizontal coefficient set so that the reference height is equal to D_n .

Item	Pita convention	Carvalho convention
Governing relation	$V/H^3 = 1.024700000000$	$V/H^3 = 1.000000000000$
Reference-height meaning	historical dimensional height	volume-equivalent nominal dimension
Relation to D_n	$D_n = 1.008166460709H$	$D_n = H$
Shared topology	two homologous sections, four plan chamfers, four circular grooves	same
Shared groove type	one circular arc per side	same
Coefficient transformation	baseline	Pita plan/groove coefficients multiplied by $f = 0.987874174182$
Volume scaling	baseline	$K_{V,C} = f^2 K_{V,P} = 1.000000000000$

Coefficient	Pita value	Carvalho value
A/H	1.086000000000	1.072831353161
B/H	1.005000000000	0.992813545052
D/H	0.024000000000	0.023708980180
R/H	0.121500000000	0.120026712163

Coefficient	Pita value	Carvalho value
E/H	0.025906459610	0.025592322393
$C/H = R/H - E/H$	0.095593540390	0.094434389770
q/H	0.118705961731	0.117266553915
$2q/H$	0.237411923462	0.234533107831
V/H^3	1.024700000000	1.000000000000

The two conventions therefore serve complementary metrological purposes. Pita preserves the historical dimensional reference. Carvalho preserves the construction logic and vectorial topology, but uses a distinct normalised coefficient set in which the reported reference height is the nominal dimension D_n .

7. Hydraulic Stability Framework

7.1 Hudson-type sizing

The Hudson formula remains a common preliminary sizing tool for Antifer armour units:

$$W = \frac{\gamma_c H_D^3}{K_D \Delta^3 \cot \alpha},$$

where:

$$\Delta = \frac{\gamma_c}{\gamma_w} - 1.$$

For concrete armour units, the formula must be used cautiously. Hudson-type sizing is valuable for preliminary comparisons, but final design depends on physical model testing, placement method, construction tolerance and acceptable damage.

A K_D value compresses many physical mechanisms into one empirical coefficient:

- unit shape;
- placement method;
- packing density;
- armour-layer porosity;
- slope;
- wave breaking and wave spectrum;
- storm duration;
- damage definition;
- underlayer and core permeability;
- wave obliquity;
- allowable rocking or displacement;
- prototype structural strength.

A K_D value without these associated conditions is not a complete design parameter.

7.2 Stability number

For comparison across density and volume, the stability number is often preferable:

$$N_s = \frac{H_s}{\Delta D_n},$$

with:

$$D_n = V^{1/3}.$$

For the Pita geometry:

$$D_n = (1.024700)^{1/3}H \approx 1.008166H.$$

This distinction matters when the drawing height H is used in hydraulic notation. The nominal diameter is not exactly equal to H unless the adopted volume convention is $V/H^3 = 1$.

7.3 Van der Meer and Antifer stability formulae

Van der Meer should not be treated only as conceptual background for Antifer design. In this paper, the hydraulic framework is interpreted in three complementary levels: Hudson-type coefficients for preliminary comparison, Van der Meer stability-number formulae for two-layer regular concrete cubes, and Antifer-specific stability-number formulae using the same empirical design structure with Antifer-calibrated coefficients.

Formula family	Typical use	Governing quantity	Interpretation for Antifer work
Hudson	preliminary sizing and comparison	K_D	useful as an equivalent stability index, but strongly dependent on placement and damage definition
Van der Meer regular-cube formula	direct preliminary design of two-layer regular cubes	$N_s = H_s/(\Delta D_n)$	relevant reference because Antifer belongs to the massive cube-derived family
Antifer-calibrated stability-number formulae	direct preliminary sizing of Antifer blocks where the coefficient set is applicable	$N_s = H_s/(\Delta D_n)$	preferred formula-based route when Antifer-specific coefficients are available
Physical modelling	final verification for important works	measured damage, rocking, displacement and overtopping	required when exposure, layout or placement differs materially from the tested basis

For double-layer regular cubes, the Van der Meer concrete-unit relation may be written as:

$$\frac{H_s}{\Delta D_n} = \left(6.7 \frac{N_{od}^{0.4}}{N^{0.3}} + 1.0 \right) s_{om}^{-0.1}.$$

The same stability-number form is also convenient for software implementation and comparison:

$$N_s = \left(k_1 \frac{N_{od}^{k_2}}{N_z^{k_3}} + k_4 \right) s_{om}^{-k_5}.$$

In this form, the coefficients define the armour-unit family and the tested slope condition.

Armour unit and slope	k_1	k_2	k_3	k_4	k_5	Comment
Regular cube, $\cot \alpha =$ 1.5	6.700000	0.400	0.300	1.000000	0.100	Van der Meer two-layer regular- cube relation
Regular cube, $\cot \alpha =$ 2.0	7.374304	0.400	0.300	1.100642	0.100	slope- adjusted regular- cube coeffi- cient form
Antifer, $\cot \alpha =$ 1.5	6.951000	0.443	0.291	1.082000	0.082	Antifer- calibrated coeffi- cient set
Antifer, $\cot \alpha =$ 2.0	6.138000	0.443	0.276	1.164000	0.070	Antifer- calibrated coeffi- cient set

The corresponding computational chain is:

Step	Expression	Meaning
1	$s_{om} = 2\pi H_s / (gT_m^2)$	deep-water wave steepness based on mean period
2	$\Delta = W_c / W_w - 1$	relative submerged density expressed with specific weights

Step	Expression	Meaning
3	$N_s = (k_1 N_{od}^{k_2} / N_z^{k_3} + k_4) s_{0m}^{-k_5}$	empirical stability number for the selected unit and slope
4	$D_n = H_s / (\Delta N_s)$	nominal armour-unit dimension
5	$V = D_n^3$	armour-unit volume by nominal diameter
6	$W = W_c D_n^3$	required concrete-unit weight

For the Pita geometric convention, D_n and the drawing height H are related by $D_n = (1.024700)^{1/3} H$. For the Carvalho convention, $D_n = H$. This distinction is important when hydraulic sizing by D_n is transferred to CAD/BIM geometry.

Formula-based Antifer sizing remains empirical. The selected coefficient set is valid only within the intended range of slope, placement, damage level, wave steepness and storm length. For important or atypical works, physical modelling remains the governing verification step, but Van der Meer-type concrete-unit formulae and Antifer-calibrated coefficient sets are direct preliminary stability tools, not merely qualitative background.

8. Placement Method, Packing Density and Damage

8.1 Why placement dominates Antifer behaviour

Antifer cubes are not independent hydraulic objects once placed in an armour layer. Their behaviour depends on the architecture of the layer. The same concrete unit may perform differently when placed:

- regularly in a square or pyramid-like pattern;
- irregularly with greater porosity and roughness;
- in a dense arrangement with reduced voids;
- in a low-density arrangement with higher roughness but reduced support;
- on a smooth or irregular underlayer;
- near the still-water level, where first displacements often initiate;
- on trunk, head, transition or roundhead sections.

The engineering variable is therefore not the Antifer cube alone, but the **Antifer armour system**.

8.2 Evidence from irregular placement studies

Irregular placement studies show that Antifer stability depends strongly on damage definition. Conservative definitions including rocking and turning tend to produce lower K_D values than definitions based only on rolling or extraction. This is important because rocking may precede fatigue, concrete damage or progressive instability.

Representative conclusions from the published irregular-placement evidence include:

- significant wave height is often a better stability descriptor than maximum wave height alone;
- average porosity around 0.47 has been reported for modified irregular placement;
- damage may increase approximately parabolically with significant wave height;
- conservative low-damage criteria can lead to K_D values of approximately 2.7 to 3.5;
- $K_D \cot \alpha$ may give a more physically consistent slope ranking than K_D alone.

8.3 Evidence from placement-pattern studies

Placement-pattern studies show that regular or semi-regular arrangements can greatly increase apparent stability. However, high packing density and high regularity may also increase reflection and overtopping. The practical issue is not simply to maximise K_D , but to find a robust compromise between stability, overtopping, reflection, construction accuracy and failure mode.

Reported Antifer coefficients across different placement methods may range from values near 4 to values above 20. This range should not be interpreted as uncertainty in the concrete geometry. It is evidence that placement architecture controls the response.

8.4 Regular versus irregular placement

The principal design compromise is:

Placement tendency	Main advantage	Main disadvantage
regular / accurately controlled	higher displacement stability	potentially higher reflection and overtopping
irregular / rougher layer	reduced overtopping and greater roughness	lower displacement stability
denser placement	greater contact restraint	lower porosity and potentially higher reflection
lower-density placement	greater porosity and roughness	greater risk of movement

For roundheads and other three-dimensional exposure zones, stability usually dominates and irregular placement may be inappropriate unless supported by specific physical-model evidence.

8.5 Consolidated stability interpretation

Source type	Main result	Use in design
historical Pita-type guidance	Antifer K_D values depend on slope and admissible damage	useful historical reference
British and international preliminary guidance	Antifer values generally treated cautiously for preliminary sizing	not a substitute for model testing
irregular-placement experiments	low-damage K_D values can be conservative	relevant for damage-sensitive projects
Frens-type placement studies	K_D strongly depends on placement and packing	demonstrates placement dominance

Source type	Main result	Use in design
regular/irregular comparative tests	regular placement improves stability; irregular placement can reduce overtopping	shows the functional trade-off

The defensible conclusion is that Antifer stability is not governed by a single coefficient. Any final design should be tested with the intended placement method, underlayer geometry, toe detail, crest arrangement, wave spectrum, water levels and damage criteria.

9. Structural Integrity and Failure Mechanisms

9.1 Why massive geometry matters

Unreinforced concrete has relatively low tensile strength compared with compressive strength. Breakage of concrete armour units is usually governed by tensile stress, fatigue, impact and cracking rather than compressive crushing. The Antifer cube reduces structural-integrity risk by avoiding slender arms. Its main resistant sections remain large, and its grooves do not create the same lever-arm vulnerability as Dolos or Tetrapod members.

Nevertheless, Antifer units are not immune to damage. They may still suffer:

- thermal cracking during curing of massive concrete;
- handling and lifting damage;
- impact damage during placement;
- abrasion and corner wear under wave action;
- rocking-induced fatigue;
- fracture caused by poor concrete quality;
- damage due to settlement or jamming in the armour layer.

9.2 Hydraulic failure versus structural failure

A design may fail by several mechanisms.

Mechanism	Description	Antifer relevance
Hydraulic displacement	unit moves out of its stable position	controlled by K_D , N_s , placement, slope and wave climate
Rocking	repeated angular movement without complete extraction	may precede fatigue or impact damage
Progressive extraction	displacement of outer units exposes lower layer or underlayer	depends on layer architecture and toe/crest confinement
Underlayer erosion	armour openings allow filter or core material loss	critical if both layers are disturbed
Structural breakage	unit fractures and loses mass or engagement	lower risk than slender units but not negligible

Mechanism	Description	Antifer relevance
Overtopping-induced rear damage	crest/rear armour affected by transmitted water	depends on crest level, roughness and porosity
Roundhead instability	3D exposure and oblique attack increase movements	generally requires conservative detailing

A complete Antifer assessment therefore requires both hydraulic and structural criteria.

9.3 Unit size and structural caution

Large Antifer blocks should be accompanied by:

- thermal control in mix design and curing;
- tensile-strength specification, not compressive strength alone;
- documented lifting and turning procedures;
- inspection for deep cracks;
- unit identification and traceability;
- mass and density control;
- post-placement survey and post-storm inspection.

10. Manufacture, Materials and Quality Control

10.1 Concrete and formwork

Antifer cubes are normally manufactured as unreinforced concrete units. Practical requirements include:

- formwork dimensions consistent with the volume specification;
- adequate stripping angles;
- no cold joints;
- layer-by-layer vibration during casting;
- immediate curing after stripping;
- thermal protection where required;
- avoidance of honeycombing and deep cracking;
- unique identification of each unit from stripping to placement.

10.2 Volume and mass control

For an armour unit whose stability is strongly mass-dependent, quality control must verify:

$$M = \rho_c V$$

or in weight notation:

$$W = W_c V.$$

A dimensional error becomes a stability error. A density error becomes a stability error. A drawing or CAD volume error becomes a procurement and construction-control error when digital models are used for quantities.

For the Pita geometry:

$$V = 1.024700H^3.$$

Therefore:

$$H = \left(\frac{W/W_c}{1.024700} \right)^{1/3}.$$

This direct relation is the most important practical consequence of the algebraic volume calculation.

10.3 Rejection and defect logic

Defects should be evaluated by structural significance, not appearance alone.

Defect type	Typical interpretation	Recommended logic
Surface bubbles or minor bleeding	often cosmetic but may indicate poor production practice	record and improve production control
Honeycombing or mass voids	may reduce mass and local strength	evaluate, reject if significant
Shallow hairline cracking	may be tolerable depending on depth and location	inspect and monitor
Deep cracking	potential fracture plane under impact/fatigue	reject or restrict to low-exposure use if allowed
Corner loss	affects mass and contact behaviour	quantify mass loss and location
Cold joint	unacceptable in unreinforced massive units	reject

11. CAD/BIM Reconstruction and Digital Metrology

11.1 Requirements for a scientific digital reconstruction

A technical reconstruction of an Antifer cube should satisfy the following conditions:

1. all dimensions are derived from named coefficients;
2. the meaning of A , B , C , D , R and E is explicit;
3. the top and bottom sections are generated from the same vectorial construction;
4. the lateral grooves are generated from the stated circular-arc equation;
5. the volume coefficient is derived from the same coefficients used in the geometry;
6. no hidden template geometry is inserted;

7. all export formats are generated from the same validated boundary-representation;
8. all non-dimensional values are reported with sufficient precision for verification.

11.2 Active production script

The associated production script is a Tkinter-based **Vectorial Antifer IFC + STL + OBJ + DXF Generator**. It generates one closed Antifer armour-unit solid from input unit weight W and concrete unit weight W_c .

Item	Script behaviour
Script type	Tkinter graphical production application
Geometry source	pure vectorial generation; no embedded CAD, SAT, ACIS, IFC, DXF or mesh template
Selectable conventions	Carvalho (2026) and Pita (1986)
Input parameters	unit weight W [kN] and concrete unit weight W_c [kN/m ³]
Volume formula	$V = W/W_c$
Height formula	$H = (V/K_V)^{1/3}$, with K_V from the selected geometric convention
Top convention	B is the top width at construction level $z = H$
Top bevel	none
Corner chamfers	lateral plan chamfers with coefficient D/H
Groove profile	one circular arc per side, with radius R and centre offset E
Groove sampling	GROOVE_ARC_POINTS = 144
IFC output	IFC4 IfcFacetedBrep with property and quantity data
STL output	closed triangular mesh in metres
OBJ output	indexed triangular mesh in metres
DXF output	AutoCAD 2018 / AC1032 ACIS-backed 3DSOLID
Text output	output.txt calculation and validation report

The Pita option preserves the historical dimensional ratios used for the Antifer reconstruction:

Coefficient	Pita value
A/H	1.086000
B/H	1.005000
D/H	0.024000
R/H	0.121500
E/H	0.025906459610
$C/H = R/H - E/H$	0.095593540390
historical K_V	1.024700
V/H^3	1.024700000000

The Carvalho option is the volume-normalised convention:

Coefficient	Carvalho value
A/H	1.072831353161
B/H	0.992813545052
D/H	0.023708980180
R/H	0.120026712163
E/H	0.025592322393
$C/H = R/H - E/H$	0.094434389770
V/H^3	1.000000000000

The two conventions use the same vectorial topology, the same two homologous horizontal sections, the same four lateral plan chamfers and the same single circular-arc groove construction. The distinction is the dimensional reference system used for H and for the corresponding non-dimensional coefficients. Carvalho is not a geometrically identical Pita block expressed with a different label for the same ratios; it is a volume-normalised coefficient set. The normalisation factor is

$$f = 0.987874174182,$$

and the Carvalho coefficients are obtained by multiplying the Pita-derived plan and groove coefficients by f . This is why the Carvalho table has different values for A/H , B/H , D/H , R/H , E/H and C/H , while the construction topology remains the same.

11.3 Verification workflow

A scientifically auditable workflow should check at least:

Check	Required result
dimensional inputs	the selected convention coefficients match the production table
no top bevel	the top face is at $z = H$ and uses B as the top width
corner chamfers	four lateral plan chamfers with coefficient D/H
groove construction	one circular arc per side, radius R and centre offset E
closed shell	every B-rep edge is shared by exactly two faces
volume relation	geometric and B-rep volumes match the selected convention
centroid convention	exported $X = 0$ and $Y = 0$ pass through the homogeneous centre of mass
bottom datum	exported $Z = 0$ remains the physical bottom level
IFC output	exact cap loops are written as IFC4 <code>IfcFacetedBrep</code> faces

Check	Required result
STL/OBJ output	triangular meshes are closed and volume-consistent
DXF output	ACIS-backed 3DSOLID is suitable for CAD inspection and mass-property checks
report output	<code>output.txt</code> records the same calculation and validation values shown in the GUI

This workflow prevents the most common digital error: producing a visually plausible Antifer geometry whose volume coefficient is not traceable to the same dimensional definitions.

12. Applications and Example Uses

Antifer cubes have been used or studied in several breakwater and maritime-protection contexts. The following examples are included as engineering context, not as direct design precedents. For any new project, the relevant parameters remain the local wave climate, water levels, slope, toe, crest, underlayer, placement pattern, unit mass, concrete density and allowable damage.

Country / region	Works / context	Role of Antifer units
France	Port of Antifer	development context and prototype application of the grooved cube concept
Portugal	Sines West Breakwater	repair and rehabilitation context under severe Atlantic exposure
Portugal	Leixões outer breakwater extension	modern rubble-mound protection using Antifer concrete blocks
Portugal	Douro Bar / Cabedelo do Douro	Antifer cube monitoring, tracking and stability assessment
Portugal / Azores	Lajes das Flores	exposed Atlantic island port protection and reconstruction context
Belgium	Zeebrugge rubble-mound breakwater	prototype-scale overtopping and run-up context on grooved cube armour
Morocco	Mohammedia	historical exposed-breakwater application context
Brunei	breakwater manufacturing / placement context	production, curing and placement references for large concrete armour units

The examples show the range of uses for massive grooved concrete cubes. They do not define

a universal stability coefficient. The governing design value must be selected for the intended armour system and verified against the project-specific hydraulic and construction conditions.

13. Design Implications

13.1 Geometry is not the controlling hydraulic uncertainty

The algebraic Pita geometry is important for technical drawings, digital consistency and correct volume interpretation. It should not, however, be interpreted as a substitute for hydraulic stability verification.

The dominant uncertainties are:

- placement method;
- packing density;
- armour slope;
- toe stability;
- underlayer permeability;
- wave climate;
- water levels;
- storm duration;
- accepted damage;
- overtopping and crest response;
- construction tolerances.

Changing or refining a geometric drawing coefficient does not justify adopting a higher K_D . The hydraulic coefficient must come from literature values applicable to the same placement system or from project-specific physical modelling.

13.2 Antifer selection is a system decision

Antifer cubes may be technically attractive when:

- quarry rock is unavailable in sufficient size or quality;
- structural robustness is more important than minimum concrete volume;
- construction conditions make strict single-layer interlocking placement difficult;
- uncertainty exists in wave climate, foundation behaviour or post-storm access;
- repair works require a conservative and familiar unit;
- high-density concrete is being considered for massive block-type units;
- the client values simple fabrication, traceability and inspection.

They may be less attractive when:

- concrete volume minimisation is the dominant criterion;
- very low overtopping is required without increasing crest height;
- the project can reliably implement strict monolayer placement;
- environmental or carbon constraints penalise high concrete consumption;
- hydraulic model testing shows unacceptable reflection or overtopping for the required layout.

13.3 Placement recommendations from the evidence

Design objective	More favourable tendency	Technical caveat
maximise displacement stability on trunk	regular or accurately controlled placement	may increase reflection and overtopping
reduce overtopping	irregular or more porous/rough layer	may reduce displacement resistance
protect roundheads	regular / high-stability arrangement	irregular placement generally not recommended where stability is critical
reduce unit breakage risk	robust massive units and marginal-displacement design	thermal and handling damage still require control
reduce construction cost	depends on unit size, placement rate and concrete volume	high-stability arrangements may require high placement accuracy
improve drawing quantity control	algebraically consistent volume coefficient	does not replace hydraulic validation

14. Limitations

The limitations of this paper are explicit:

- no new hydraulic model tests were performed;
- no new prototype monitoring was performed;
- no finite-element structural-integrity model was produced;
- the production script is a geometric CAD/BIM generator; it is not a complete hydraulic design tool;
- the adoption table is not an exhaustive global catalogue;
- project-specific design still requires wave climate, water levels, toe, underlayer, crest, overtopping, transmission, construction sequence, geotechnics and damage criteria;
- critical works should be verified by physical modelling or equivalent project-specific evidence.

15. Conclusions

The geometric conclusions are summarised below to keep the dimensional conventions auditable and to avoid mixing drawing notation, volume normalisation and hydraulic design assumptions.

Topic	Conclusion
Unit type	Antifer cubes are massive grooved unreinforced concrete armour units developed in France in the early 1970s in connection with the Port of Antifer.

Topic	Conclusion
Engineering role	The unit is best described as an improved massive cube: the grooves improve hydraulic interaction and reduce face-to-face rearrangement, while the thick body preserves structural robustness.
Structural classification	The Antifer cube should not be classified as a slender high-interlock unit; its advantage is conservative robustness, not minimum concrete consumption.
Pita top convention	The production geometry has no top bevel. The top face is a single horizontal plane at $z = H$, and B is the top bounding width at that level.
Chamfer convention	D is a lateral corner-chamfer offset in plan and not a vertical top-bevel dimension.
Groove convention	Each lateral groove is one circular arc of radius R , with centre offset E and no auxiliary straight inner segment.
Pita exact groove inset	The exact groove inset generated by the circular arc is $C/H = 0.095593540390$; the historical $C/H = 0.095600$ is the rounded notation.
Pita nominal diameter	For the Pita geometry, $D_n = (1.024700)^{1/3}H = 1.008166460709H$, so D_n is not exactly equal to H .
Carvalho reference height	Carvalho uses $V/H^3 = 1.000000$, so $H = D_n = V^{1/3}$.
Carvalho coefficients	Carvalho does not preserve the Pita ratios A/H , B/H , D/H , R/H and E/H unchanged; it applies a common horizontal factor $f = 0.987874174182$.

The complete volume balances are as follows.

Convention	Gross frustum	Chamfers	Grooves	Final V/H^3
Pita	1.093617000000	0.001152000000	0.067765000000	1.024700000000
Carvalho	1.067255782180	0.001124231482	0.066131550698	1.000000000000

The design conclusions are distinct from the geometric conclusions.

Design topic	Conclusion
Stability coefficient	Reported Antifer K_D values vary widely because K_D is system-dependent and controlled by placement pattern, packing density, wave conditions, slope and damage definition.
Van der Meer framework	Van der Meer concrete-unit formulae provide direct preliminary stability relations for regular two-layer cubes, and Antifer stability can be treated with the same stability-number structure when Antifer-calibrated coefficients are used.
Nominal diameter transfer	Hydraulic sizing is naturally expressed through $D_n = V^{1/3}$; Pita uses $D_n = 1.008166460709H$, while Carvalho uses $D_n = H$.
Placement trade-off	Regular placement tends to improve displacement stability, while irregular placement tends to reduce overtopping. This is a functional trade-off, not a contradiction.
Workflow separation	A defensible Antifer workflow must distinguish historical dimensional references, volume-normalised dimensional references, generated digital geometry and hydraulic design assumptions.
Project verification	Final project design should not rely on geometric standardisation alone. It must be verified against the actual armour-layer arrangement, wave climate, allowable damage and construction tolerances.

16. Data and Code Availability

The digital implementation associated with this paper is the **Vectorial Antifer IFC + STL + OBJ + DXF Generator** by Ricardo Carvalho (2026).

Output	Description
IFC	IFC4 IfcFacetedBrep model with property and quantity data
STL	closed triangular surface mesh in metres
OBJ	indexed triangular surface mesh in metres
DXF	AutoCAD 2018 / AC1032 file with an ACIS-backed 3DSOLID
TXT	output.txt calculation and validation report

The two selectable dimensional conventions are defined by the following production coefficient table.

Coefficient	Pita (1986)	Carvalho (2026)
$K_V = V/H^3$	1.024700000000	1.000000000000
A/H	1.086000000000	1.072831353161
B/H	1.005000000000	0.992813545052
D/H	0.024000000000	0.023708980180
R/H	0.121500000000	0.120026712163
E/H	0.025906459610	0.025592322393
$C/H = R/H - E/H$	0.095593540390	0.094434389770
q/H	0.118705961731	0.117266553915
$2q/H$	0.237411923462	0.234533107831

Implementation principle	Adopted value or behaviour
Geometry source	pure vectorial B-rep generation
Embedded templates	none
Top face	single horizontal plane at $z = H$
Lateral grooves	single circular arc per side
Shared export source	same validated geometric source for IFC, STL, OBJ and DXF
Pita reference	historical dimensional coefficient set with $V/H^3 = 1.024700$
Carvalho reference	volume-normalised coefficient set with $V/H^3 = 1.000000$
Carvalho normalisation	horizontal plan/groove factor $f = 0.987874174182$

17. Acknowledgement and Dedication

This work is respectfully dedicated to the memory of **Carlos Alberto Roldão Maia Pita** (1950-2002), Portuguese civil engineer and specialist in maritime hydraulics and rubble-mound breakwater design. His LNEC *Memória n.º 670 — Dimensionamento Hidráulico do Manto Resistente de Quebra-Mares de Talude* remains an important technical reference for Portuguese maritime engineering and provides a key historical basis for the geometric interpretation of Antifer cubes.

18. References

1. Pita, C. A. R. M. *Dimensionamento Hidráulico do Manto Resistente de Quebra-Mares de Talude*. Laboratório Nacional de Engenharia Civil, Memória n.º 670, Lisboa, 1986.
2. BSI. *BS 6349-7:1991 Maritime structures — Part 7: Guide to the design and construction of breakwaters*, with 2010 corrigenda.
3. CIRIA; CUR; CETMEF. *The Rock Manual: The use of rock in hydraulic engineering*, 2nd ed., 2007.
4. U.S. Army Corps of Engineers. *Coastal Engineering Manual*. Engineer Manual EM 1110-2-1100, U.S. Army Corps of Engineers, Washington, D.C., 6 volumes, 2002. Official USACE Publications repository.

5. Yagci, O.; Kapdasli, S.; Cigizoglu, H. K. “The stability of the antifer units used on breakwaters in case of irregular placement”, *Ocean Engineering*, 31, 1111-1127, 2004.
 6. Frens, A. B. *The Impact of Placement Method on Antifer-block Stability*. MSc thesis, Delft University of Technology, 2007.
 7. Neves, M. G.; Silva, L. G.; Reither, S. *Stability and overtopping of rubble-mound breakwaters: influence of the placement method and density of cubic blocks*. LNEC / PIANC Portugal.
 8. Chegini, V.; Aghtouman, P. Hydraulic stability formulae for Antifer blocks, 2006.
 9. Freitas, P. M. G. *Hydraulic Stability of Antifer Cubes: Physical Model Study*. MSc dissertation, Instituto Superior Técnico, 2013.
 10. Scaravaglione, G.; Latham, J.-P.; Xiang, J.; Francone, A.; Tomasicchio, G. R. “Historical overview of the structural integrity of Concrete Armour Units”, 2022.
 11. Edge, B. L.; Magoon, O. T.; et al. / ASCE-ICCE documentation on the rehabilitation of the West Breakwater of Sines and the use of high-density Antifer cubes.
 12. Reis, M. T.; Fortes, C. J. E. M.; Neves, M. G.; et al. “Rehabilitation of Sines west breakwater: wave overtopping study”, *Proceedings of the Institution of Civil Engineers - Maritime Engineering*, 2011.
 13. Troch, P.; De Rouck, J.; Van Damme, L. “Full-scale wave-overtopping measurements on the Zeebrugge rubble mound breakwater”, *Coastal Engineering*, 2004.
 14. Geeraerts, J.; De Rouck, J.; Troch, P.; et al. “Effects of new variables on the overtopping discharge at steep rubble mound breakwaters: the Zeebrugge prototype case”, 2009.
 15. Jensen, O. J. Historical syntheses on the evolution of armour units and recent observations on Antifer behaviour on highly exposed breakwaters, including references to Antifer, Mohammedia and Zeebrugge.
 16. Luís, L.; Freire, S.; Barros, J.; Lopes, H.; Lemos, R.; Fortes, C.; Neves, G. “Estudos e projetos do prolongamento do quebra-mar exterior e das acessibilidades marítimas do Porto de Leixões”, PIANC Portugal / LNEC, 2022.
 17. Teixeira Duarte. “Extension of the Outer Breakwater and Maritime Access Ways of Leixões Port”, project description with Antifer block quantities and classes.
 18. Portos dos Açores / NRV-Norvia / PORTUS. Documentation on the emergency protection and reconstruction of the Port of Lajes das Flores after Hurricane Lorenzo and subsequent storm damage.
-